

Beacon - AI Personal Career Coach

Group 11

Manavi Chaudhry • Chu-Yun Hwang • Jennie Lee • Meet Kailash Mali

AI / Tool Usage Disclosure

Beacon - AI Personal Career Coach

Wireframes developed using AI-assisted design tools.

Tool: ChatGPT

Model: GPT-5.6 Luna

Purpose of AI Usage:

AI was used to assist with the development of low-fidelity interface concepts, screen structure, responsive layouts, and interaction ideas. The final wireframe structure and feature selection were determined based on the team's project requirements and application concept.

Application

Beacon is an AI Personal Career Coach designed to help students prepare for the job market through personalized assessment, planning, practice, progress tracking, and interview feedback.



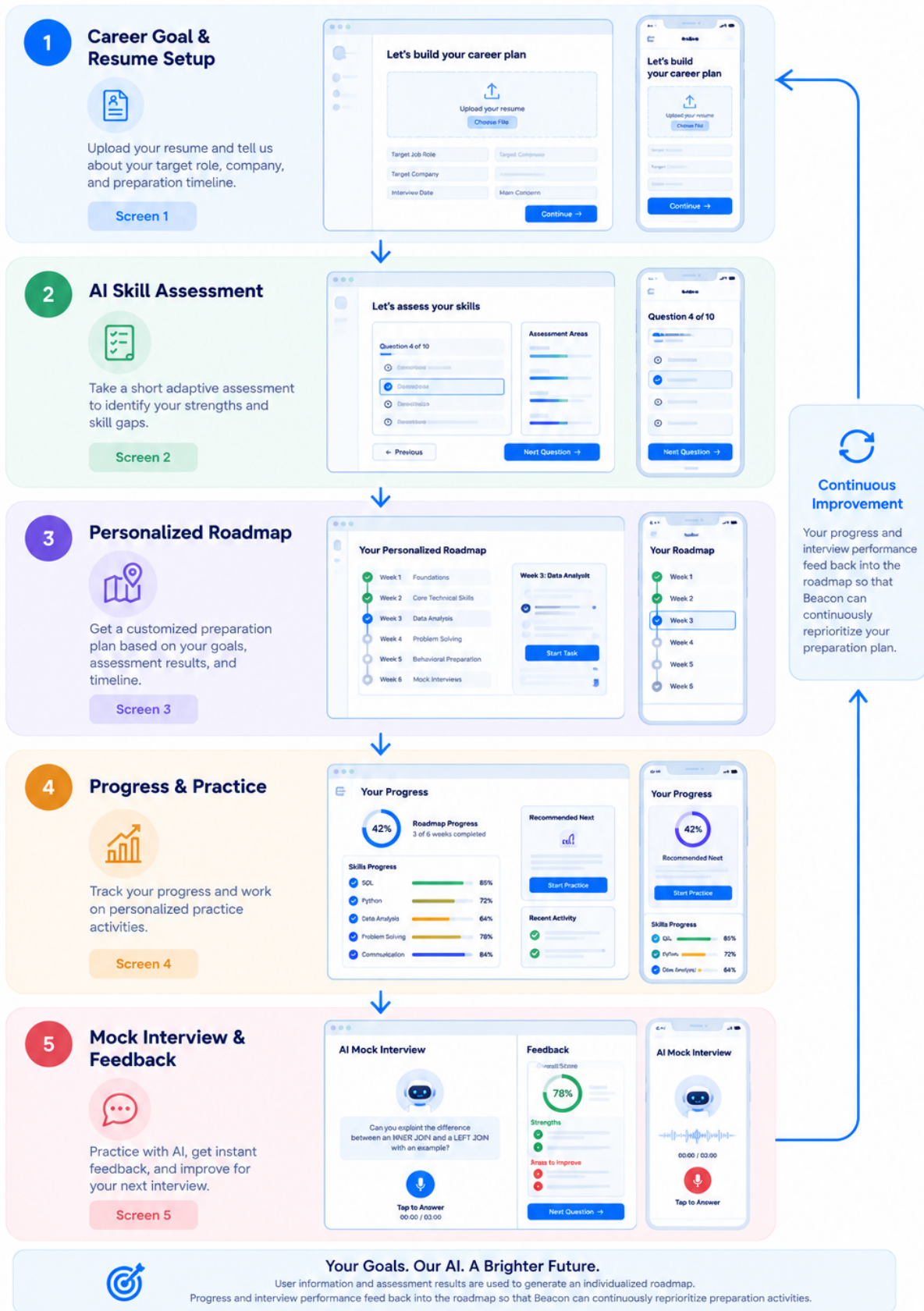
Beacon

Your AI Career Coach

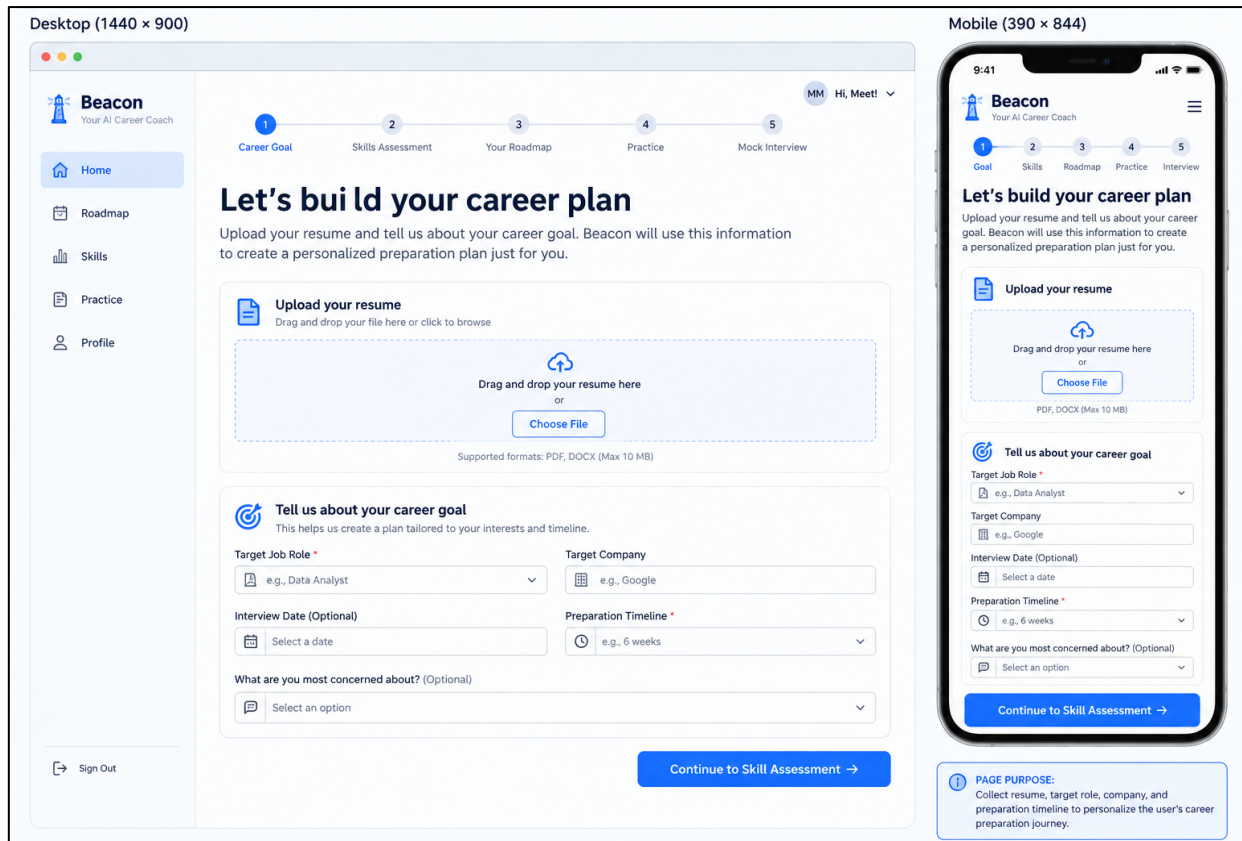
From Preparation to Opportunity
Plan | Practice | Progress | Succeed

Application Screen Flow

A step-by-step journey to help you land your dream job.



Screen 1: Career Goal & Resume Setup



Key UI Elements

- Beacon branding and primary navigation: Home, Roadmap, Skills, Practice, Profile.
- Five-step progress indicator showing Career Goal → Skills → Roadmap → Practice → Mock Interview.
- Resume upload area with drag-and-drop support and a Choose File button.
- Career Goal form with Target Job Role, Target Company, Interview Date, Preparation Timeline, and optional primary concern.
- Primary action button: “Continue to Skill Assessment →”.

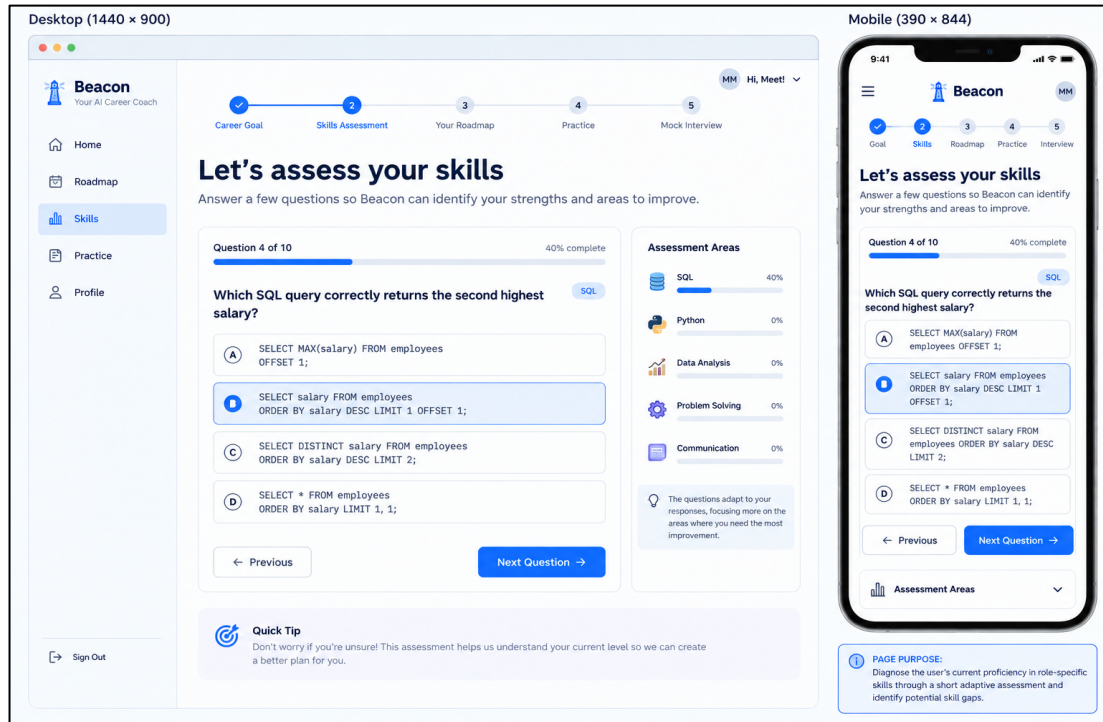
Intended User Interactions

- User uploads a resume by dragging and dropping a file or selecting Choose File.
- User enters or selects their target job role and company.
- User provides an interview date or preparation timeline.
- User may identify their primary preparation concern.
- User selects Continue to Skill Assessment to proceed to Screen 2.

PAGE PURPOSE

Collect the user's resume, target role, company, and preparation timeline to personalize their career preparation journey.

Screen 2: AI Skill Assessment



Key UI Elements

- Beacon branding and consistent navigation.
- Five-step progress indicator with Skills Assessment highlighted.
- Assessment progress indicator showing the current question, such as “Question 4 of 10”.
- Single multiple-choice question card.
- Four selectable answer options with a clear selected state.
- Assessment Areas panel showing skills such as SQL, Python, Data Analysis, Problem Solving, and Communication.
- Previous and primary “Next Question →” buttons.

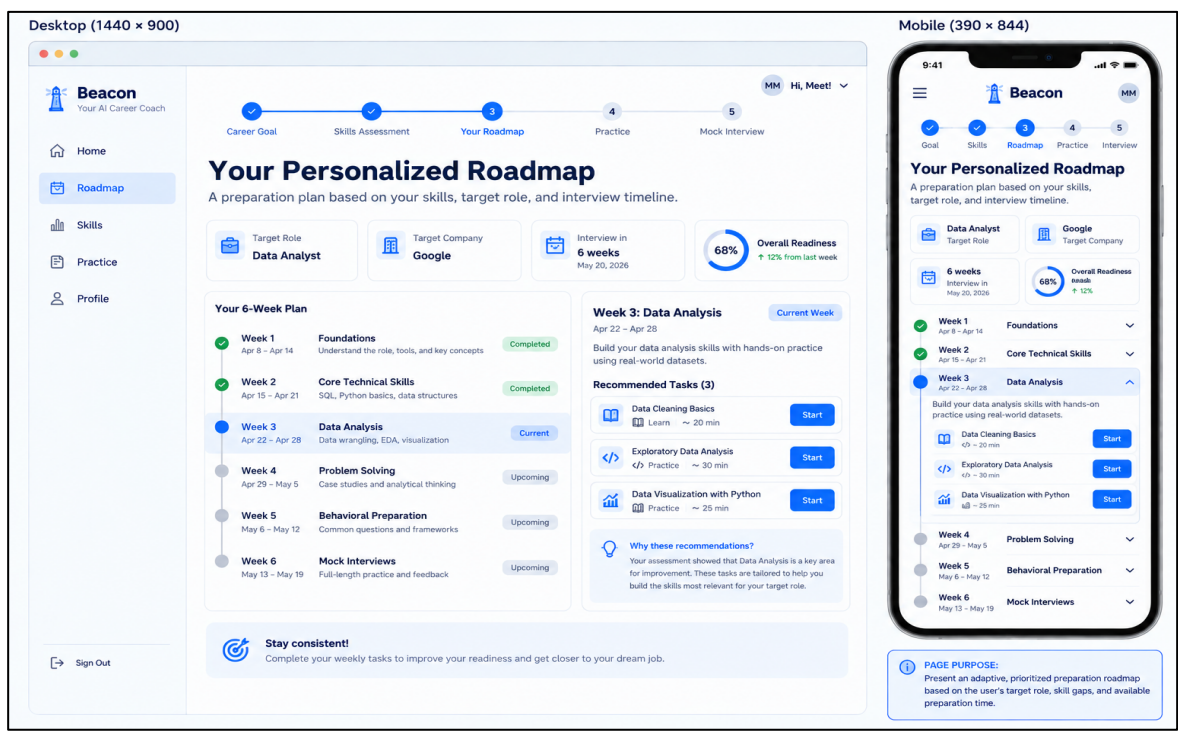
Intended User Interactions

- User reads one role-specific question at a time.
- User selects one answer choice.
- Selected answer is visually distinguished.
- User selects Next Question to continue.
- Beacon adapts subsequent questions based on the user's responses.
- After completion, assessment results are used to generate the personalized roadmap.

PAGE PURPOSE

Diagnose the user's current proficiency in role-specific skills through a short adaptive assessment and identify potential skill gaps.

Screen 3: Personalized Roadmap



Key UI Elements

- Beacon branding and primary navigation.
- Five-step progress indicator with Your Roadmap highlighted.
- Goal summary showing Target Role, Target Company, Interview Timeline, and Overall Readiness.
- Six-week preparation timeline.
- Status indicators for Completed, Current, and Upcoming stages.
- Expanded current-week section showing recommended preparation tasks.
- Primary “Start Task” action.
- “Why these recommendations?” explanation connecting tasks to assessment results.

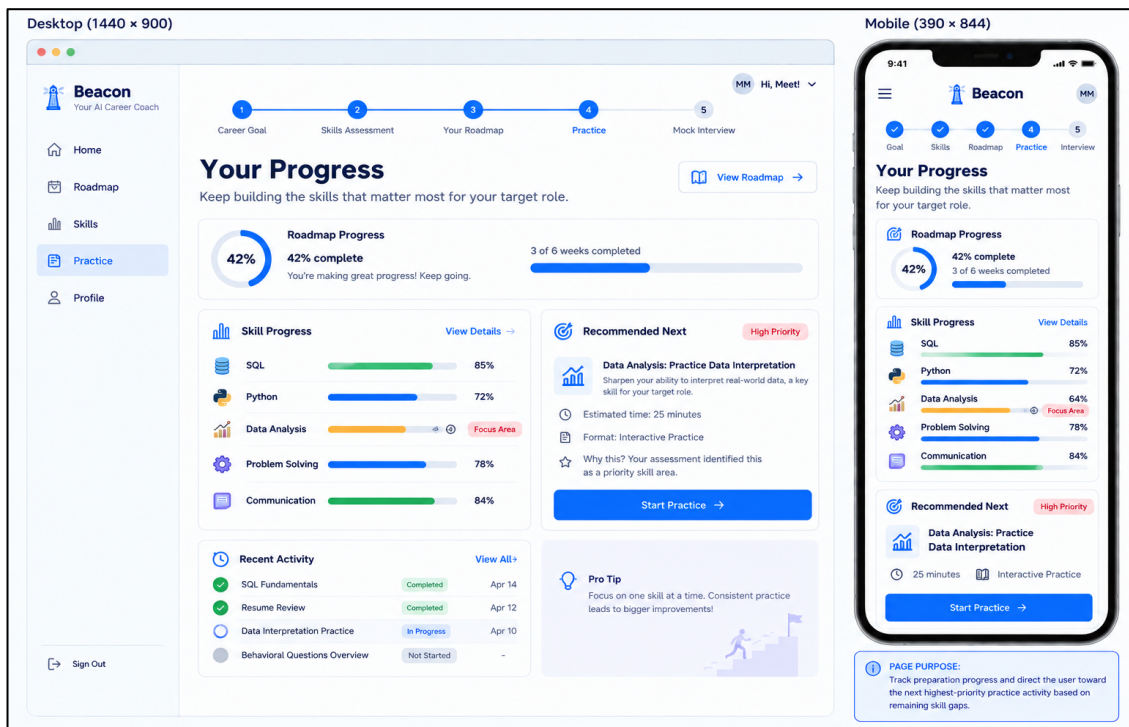
Intended User Interactions

- User selects a week in the roadmap.
- User expands a roadmap stage to view recommended tasks.
- User selects Start Task to begin a preparation activity.
- Completed tasks update roadmap progress.
- Beacon can reprioritize future tasks as the user's performance changes.

PAGE PURPOSE

Present an adaptive, prioritized preparation roadmap based on the user's target role, skill gaps, and available preparation time.

Screen 4: Progress & Practice



Key UI Elements

- Beacon branding and primary navigation.
- Five-step progress indicator with Practice highlighted.
- Overall Roadmap Progress indicator.
- Skill Progress section with individual skill bars or percentages.
- Highlighted focus area representing the highest-priority skill gap.
- Recommended Next activity card with estimated time and reason for recommendation.
- Primary “Start Practice →” button.
- Recent Activity section showing completed, in-progress, and not-started activities.
- Secondary “View Roadmap →” action.

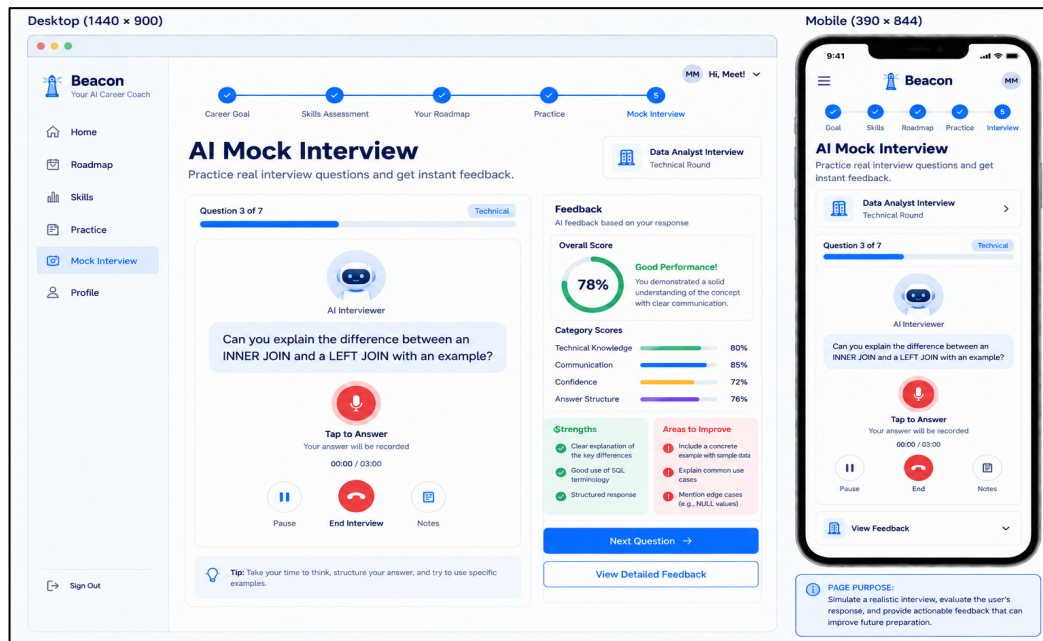
Intended User Interactions

- User reviews overall roadmap and individual skill progress.
- User identifies the highlighted focus area.
- User reads why Beacon recommended the next activity.
- User selects Start Practice to begin the recommended activity.
- Completing an activity updates progress and may change the next recommendation.
- User can return to the roadmap to review the larger preparation plan.

PAGE PURPOSE

Track preparation progress and direct the user toward the next highest-priority practice activity based on remaining skill gaps.

Screen 5: AI Mock Interview & Feedback



Key UI Elements

- Beacon branding and primary navigation.
- Five-step progress indicator with Mock Interview highlighted.
- Interview context showing target role and interview round.
- Question progress indicator, such as “Question 3 of 7”.
- AI interviewer represented by a simple icon/avatar.
- Interview question area.
- Microphone / recording control with timer and recording status.
- Pause, End Interview, and Notes controls.
- Feedback summary with Overall Score and category scores.
- Strengths and Areas to Improve sections.
- Primary “View Detailed Feedback” or “Next Question →” action.

Intended User Interactions

- User starts the mock interview.
- User reads or listens to the interview question.
- User selects the microphone control and records an answer.
- User can pause, end the interview, or access notes.
- User submits the response for evaluation.
- Beacon provides an overall score, strengths, and areas for improvement.
- User views detailed feedback or continues to the next question.
- Interview performance can feed back into Beacon's roadmap and future practice recommendations.

PAGE PURPOSE

Simulate a realistic interview, evaluate the user's response, and provide actionable feedback that can improve future preparation.

Design Choices & Rationale

Overall Design Approach

Beacon uses a simple, light-themed, responsive interface designed to reduce the sense of overwhelm that can accompany job preparation. Instead of presenting many features on one dashboard, the application guides users through five focused stages: setting a goal, assessing skills, receiving a roadmap, practicing, and completing mock interviews. Each screen emphasizes one primary task and a clear next step.

Layout & Flow Justification

The five-screen sequence follows a logical progression from understanding the user to evaluating their current abilities, creating a plan, supporting preparation, and evaluating interview performance. This structure allows Beacon to use information collected earlier in the process to personalize later stages. The final interview-feedback stage creates a feedback loop in which performance can influence future preparation recommendations.

Design Principles Applied

Principle	Application in Beacon
Gestalt - Proximity	Related information is grouped together. For example, each roadmap week groups its topic, status, dates, and recommended tasks.
Fitts's Law	Primary actions such as Continue, Next Question, Start Practice, and interview controls are given prominent placement and sufficiently large interaction targets.
Hick's Law	Each screen limits the number of visible choices and focuses users on the most relevant action rather than presenting every available feature.
Cognitive Load Theory	The complex process of career preparation is divided into five manageable stages. The assessment and interview screens also present one question at a time.
Norman's Design Principles	Buttons, upload areas, selectable answers, form fields, and recording controls use familiar visual affordances so users can understand how to interact with them.
Nielsen — Visibility of System Status	Progress bars, question numbers, roadmap statuses, skill percentages, and recording indicators communicate the user's current state.
Recognition Rather Than Recall	Users can see their goals, progress, skill levels, recommendations, and current roadmap stage rather than having to remember previous actions.
Consistency	The same navigation structure, typography, button treatment, progress indicators, terminology, and visual hierarchy are maintained across screens and responsive layouts.

Accessibility	The interface prioritizes readable typography, clear labels, strong visual hierarchy, recognizable controls, sufficient contrast, and large touch targets on mobile devices.
Simplicity	The interface intentionally avoids a dense dashboard. Each screen has a primary purpose and presents only the information needed to complete that stage.

Responsive Design

Each screen is represented in both desktop and mobile dimensions. The same core information and interactions are preserved across devices, while content is reorganized vertically on smaller screens. This supports consistency while accounting for differences in available screen space and touch interaction.

Interaction Strategy

Beacon uses a clear primary-action pattern throughout the experience. Users are guided from one meaningful step to the next rather than being asked to choose from a large number of features. Progress indicators and feedback help users understand where they are, what they have accomplished, and what they should do next.

Design Goal:

Beacon does not show users everything they could do, it helps them understand what they should do next.